

Struwwelpeter

MERRY STORIES AND FUNNY PICTURES

Heinrich Hoffman



FREDERICK WARNE & CO., INC. NEW YORK

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STRUWWELPETER: MERRY STORIES AND FUNNY PICTURES ***

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Merry Stories And Funny Pictures

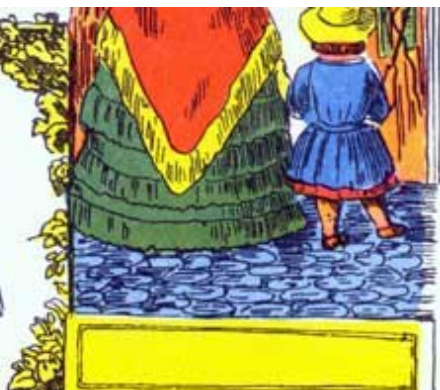


When the children have been
good,
That is, be it understood,
Good at meal-times, good at
play,
Good all night and good all day
—

They shall have the pretty things
Merry Christmas always brings.

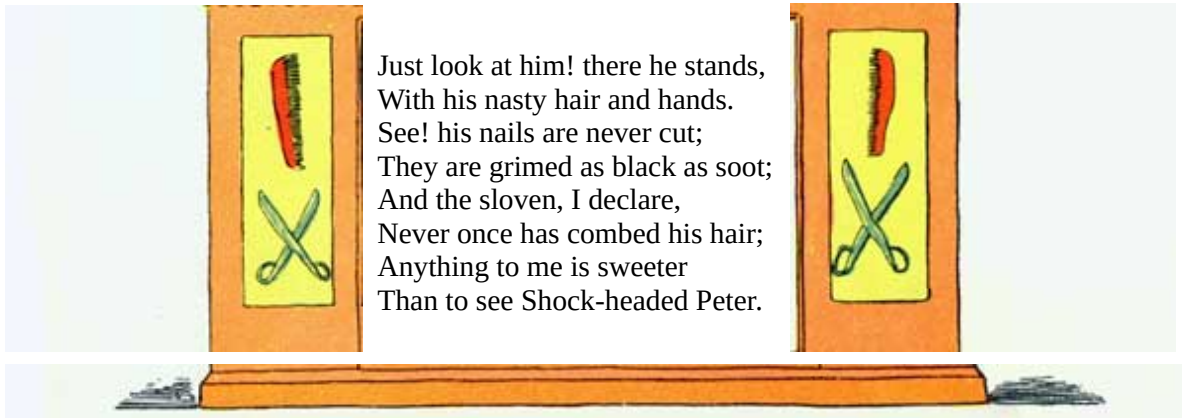


Naughty, romping girls and boys
Tear their clothes and make a
noise,
Spoil their pinafores and frocks,
And deserve no Christmas-box.
Such as these shall never look
At this pretty Picture-book.



Shock-headed Peter



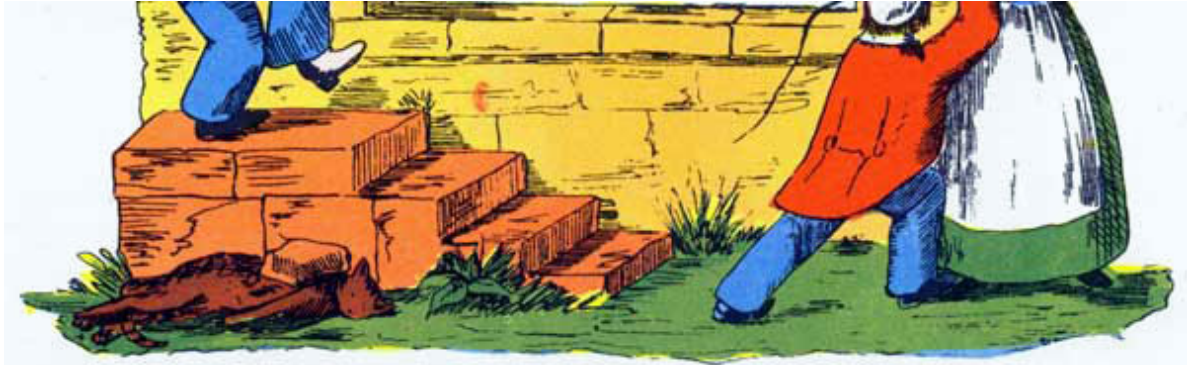
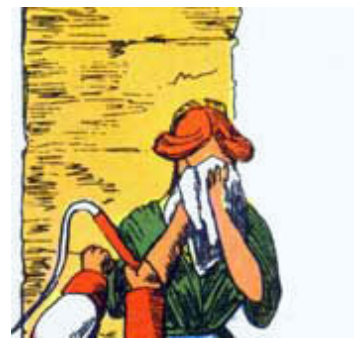


Cruel Frederick





Here is cruel Frederick, see!
A horrid wicked boy was he;
He caught the flies, poor little
things,
And then tore off their tiny wings,
He killed the birds, and broke the
chairs,
And threw the kitten down the
stairs;
And oh! far worse than all beside,
He whipped his Mary, till she cried.





The trough was full, and
faithful Tray
Came out to drink one sultry
day;
He wagged his tail, and wet
his lip,
When cruel Fred snatched up a
whip,
And whipped poor Tray till he
was sore,
And kicked and whipped him
more and more:
At this, good Tray grew very
red,
And growled, and bit him till
he bled;
Then you should only have
been by,
To see how Fred did scream
and cry!





So Frederick had to go to bed:
His leg was very sore and red!
The Doctor came, and shook his
head,
And made a very great to-do,
And gave him nasty physic too.



But good dog Tray is happy now;
He has no time to say "Bow-
wow!"
He seats himself in Frederick's
chair
And laughs to see the nice things
there:
The soup he swallows, sup by
sup—
And eats the pies and puddings
up.



The Dreadful Story of Harriet and the Matches

It almost makes me cry
to tell
What foolish Harriet
befell.
Mamma and Nurse went
out one day
And left her all alone at
play.
Now, on the table close
at hand,
A box of matches
chanced to stand;
And kind Mamma and
Nurse had told her,
That, if she touched
them, they would scold
her.
But Harriet said: "Oh,
what a pity!
For, when they burn, it
is so pretty;
They crackle so, and
spit, and flame:
Mamma, too, often does
the same."

The pussy-cats heard
this,
And they began to hiss,
And stretch their claws,
And raise their paws;
"Me-ow," they said,
"me-ow, me-o,
You'll burn to death, if
you do so."



But Harriet would not
take advice:
She lit a match, it was so
nice!
It crackled so, it burned
so clear—
Exactly like the picture
here.
She jumped for joy and
ran about
And was too pleased to
put it out.

The Pussy-cats saw this
And said: "Oh, naughty,
naughty Miss!"
And stretched their
claws,
And raised their paws:
"'Tis very, very wrong,
you know,
Me-ow, me-o, me-ow,
me-o,
You will be burnt, if you
do so."

And see! oh, what
dreadful thing!
The fire has caught her
apron-string;
Her apron burns, her
arms, her hair—
She burns all over
everywhere.

Then how the pussy-cats
did mew—
What else, poor pussies,
could they do?
They screamed for help,
'twas all in vain!
So then they said: "We'll
scream again;
Make haste, make haste,
me-ow, me-o,
She'll burn to death; we
told her so."

So she was burnt, with
all her clothes,
And arms, and hands,
and eyes, and nose;
Till she had nothing
more to lose
Except her little scarlet
shoes;
And nothing else but
these was found
Among her ashes on the
ground.



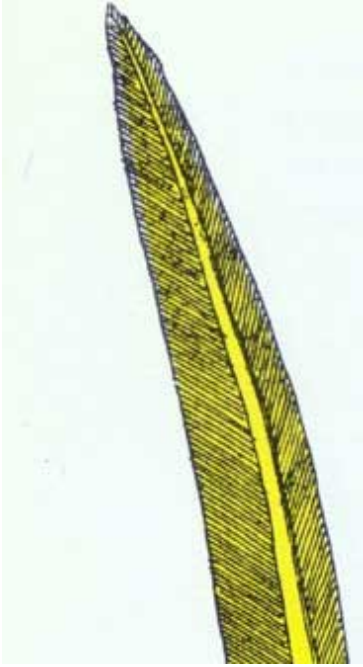
And when the good cats
sat beside
The smoking ashes, how
they cried!
"Me-ow, me-oo, me-ow,
me-oo,
What will Mamma and
Nurse do?"
Their tears ran down
their cheeks so fast,
They made a little pond
at last.

The Story of the Inky Boys



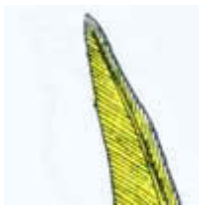
As he had often done
 before,
 The woolly-headed
 Black-a-moor
 One nice fine summer's
 day went out
 To see the shops, and
 walk about;
 And, as he found it hot,
 poor fellow,
 He took with him his
 green umbrella,
 Then Edward, little noisy
 wag,
 Ran out and laughed, and
 waved his flag;
 And William came in
 jacket trim,
 And brought his wooden
 hoop with him;
 And Arthur, too, snatched
 up his toys
 And joined the other
 naughty boys.
 So, one and all set up a
 roar,
 And laughed and hooted
 more and more,
 And kept on singing,—
 only think!—
 "Oh, Blacky, you're as
 black as ink!"





Now tall Agrippa lived close by—
So tall, he almost touched the sky;
He had a mighty inkstand, too,
In which a great goose-feather
grew;
He called out in an angry tone
"Boys, leave the Black-a-moor
alone!
For, if he tries with all his might,
He cannot change from black to
white."
But, ah! they did not mind a bit
What great Agrippa said of it;
But went on laughing, as before,
And hooting at the Black-a-moor.





Then great Agrippa foams with rage—
Look at him on this very page!
He seizes Arthur, seizes Ned,
Takes William by his little head;

And they may scream and kick and call,
Into the ink he dips them all;
Into the inkstand, one, two, three,
Till they are black as black can be;
Turn over now, and you shall see.





See, there they are, and
there they run!
The Black-a-moor
enjoys the fun.
They have been made
as black as crows,
Quite black all over,
eyes and nose,
And legs, and arms, and
heads, and toes,
And trousers, pinafores,
and toys—
The silly little inky
boys!
Because they set up
such a roar,
And teased the harmless
Black-a-moor.

The Story of the Man that went out Shooting

This is the man that shoots the hares;
This is the coat he always wears:
With game-bag, powder-horn, and gun
He's going out to have some fun.

He finds it hard, without a pair
Of spectacles, to shoot the hare.

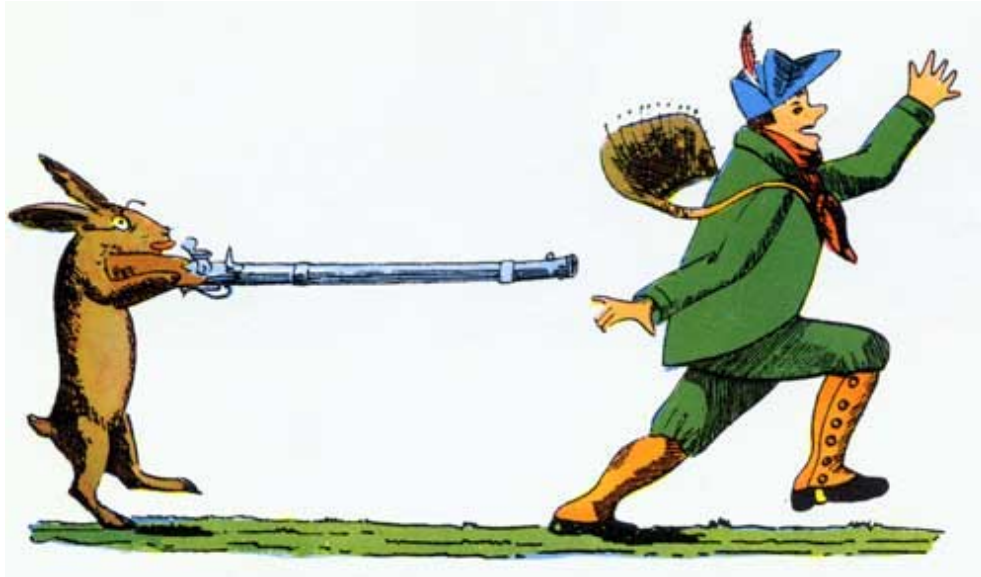


The hare sits snug in
leaves and grass
And laughs to see the
green man pass.



Now, as the sun grew
very hot,
And he a heavy gun had
got,
He lay down
underneath a tree
And went to sleep, as
you may see.
And, while he slept like
any top,
The little hare came,
hop, hop, hop,
Took gun and
spectacles, and then
On her hind legs went
off again.

The green man wakes and sees her place
The spectacles upon her face;
And now she's trying all she can
To shoot the sleepy, green-coat man.
He cries and screams and runs away;
The hare runs after him all day
And hears him call out everywhere:
"Help! Fire! Help! The Hare! The Hare!"



At last he stumbled at the well,
Head over ears, and in he fell.
The hare stopped short, took aim and, hark!
Bang went the gun—she missed her mark!



The poor man's wife was drinking up
Her coffee in her coffee-cup;

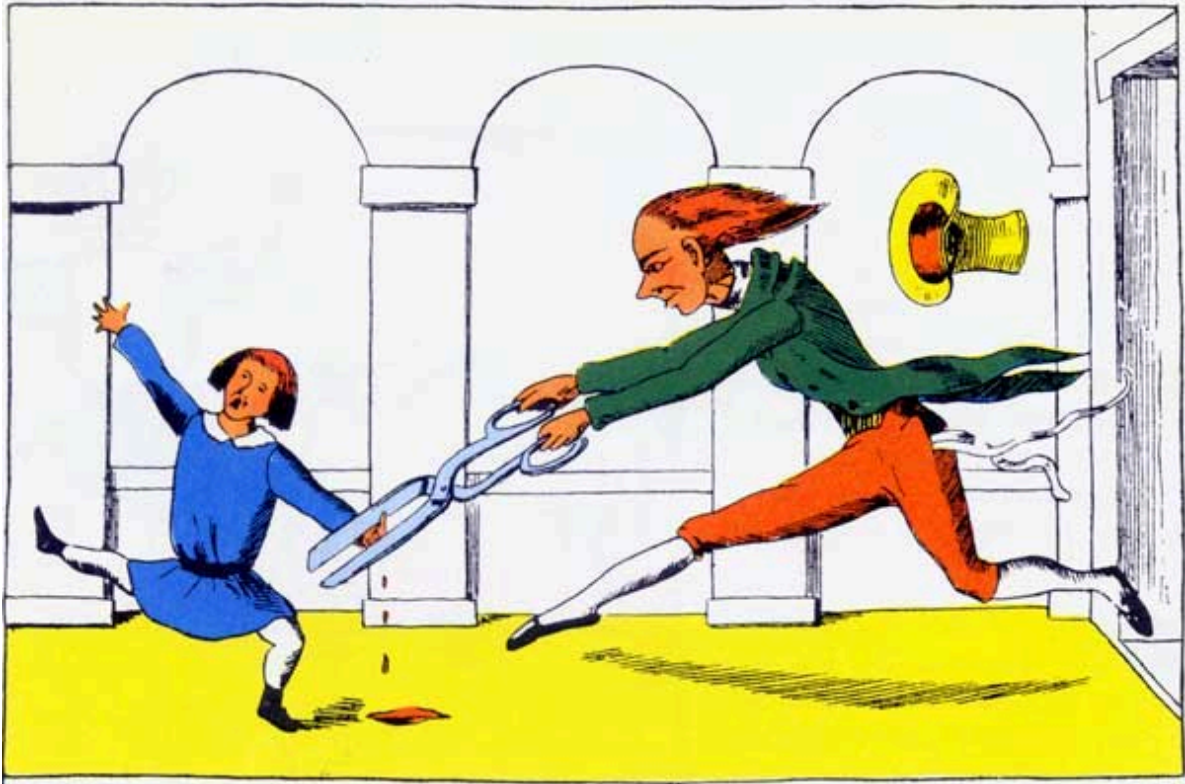
The gun shot cup and saucer through;
"Oh dear!" cried she; "what shall I do?"
There lived close by the cottage there
The hare's own child, the little hare;
And while she stood upon her toes,
The coffee fell and burned her nose.
"Oh dear!" she cried, with spoon in hand,
"Such fun I do not understand."

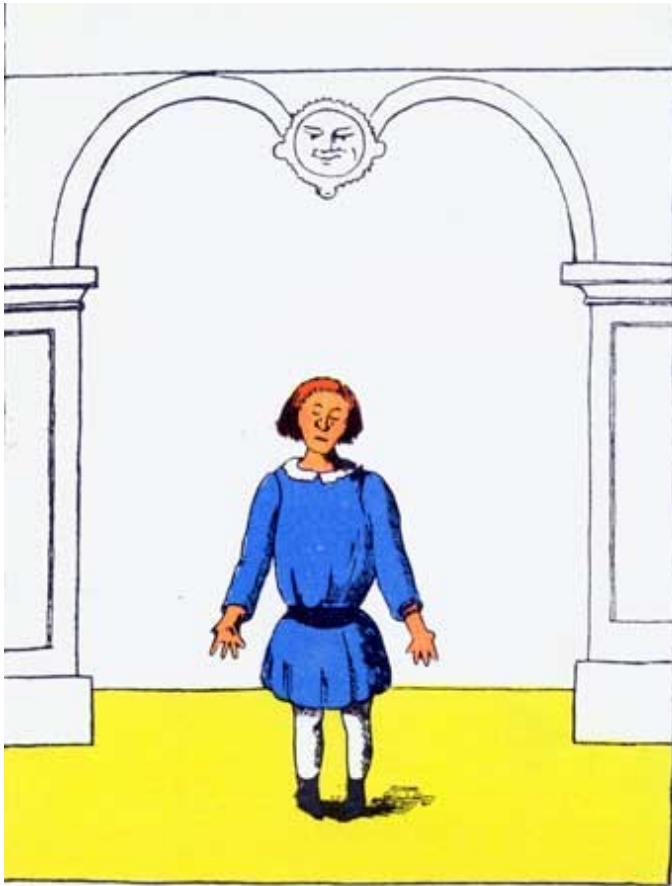
The Story of Little Suck-a-Thumb

One day Mamma said
"Conrad dear,
I must go out and leave
you here.
But mind now, Conrad,
what I say,
Don't suck your thumb
while I'm away.
The great tall tailor
always comes
To little boys who suck
their thumbs;
And ere they dream what
he's about,
He takes his great sharp
scissors out,
And cuts their thumbs
clean off—and then,
You know, they never
grow again."

Mamma had scarcely
turned her back,
The thumb was in,
Alack! Alack!







The door flew open, in he ran,
The great, long, red-legged
scissor-man.

Oh! children, see! the tailor's
come

And caught out little Suck-a-
Thumb.

Snip! Snap! Snip! the scissors
go;

And Conrad cries out "Oh!
Oh! Oh!"

Snip! Snap! Snip! They go so
fast,
That both his thumbs are off at
last.

Mamma comes home: there
Conrad stands,
And looks quite sad, and
shows his hands;
"Ah!" said Mamma, "I knew
he'd come
To naughty little Suck-a-
Thumb."

**The Story of Augustus,
who would not have any Soup**



Augustus was a chubby lad;
Fat ruddy cheeks Augustus
had:

And everybody saw with joy
The plump and hearty,
healthy boy.

He ate and drank as he was
told,
And never let his soup get
cold.

But one day, one cold
winter's day,
He screamed out "Take the
soup away!
O take the nasty soup away!
I won't have any soup
today."

Next day, now look, the
picture shows
How lank and lean Augustus
grows!

Yet, though he feels so weak
and ill,
The naughty fellow cries out
still

"Not any soup for me, I say:
O take the nasty soup away!
I *won't* have any soup
today."

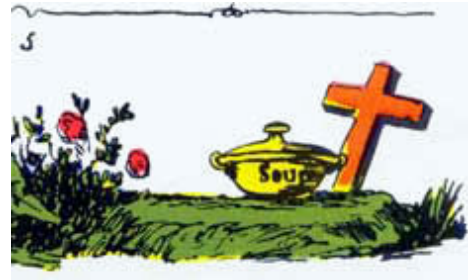
The third day comes: Oh
what a sin!

To make himself so pale and
thin.

Yet, when the soup is put on
table,
He screams, as loud as he is

able,
"Not any soup for me, I say:
O take the nasty soup away!
I WON'T have any soup
today."

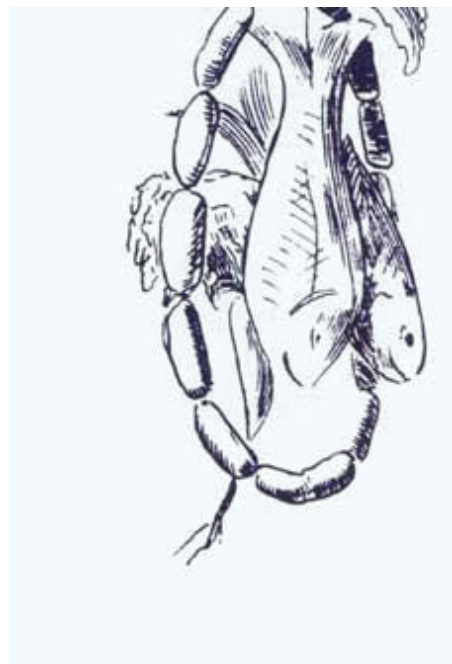
Look at him, now the fourth
day's come!
He scarcely weighs a sugar-
plum;
He's like a little bit of
thread,
And, on the fifth day, he was
—dead!



The Story of Fidgety Philip



"Let me see if Philip can
Be a little gentleman;
Let me see if he is able
To sit still for once at
table":
Thus Papa bade Phil
behave;
And Mamma looked very
grave.
But fidgety Phil,
He won't sit still;
He wriggles,
And giggles,
And then, I declare,
Swings backwards and
forwards,
And tilts up his chair,
Just like any rocking
horse—
"Philip! I am getting
cross!"



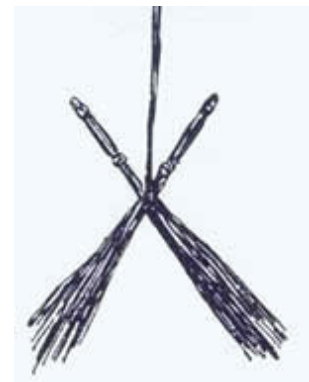


See the naughty, restless child
 Growing still more rude and wild,
 Till his chair falls over quite.
 Philip screams with all his might,
 Catches at the cloth, but then
 That makes matters worse again.
 Down upon the ground they fall,
 Glasses, plates, knives, forks, and
 all.
 How Mamma did fret and frown,
 When she saw them tumbling
 down!
 And Papa made such a face!
 Philip is in sad disgrace.





Where is Philip, where is he?
 Fairly covered up you see!
 Cloth and all are lying on him;
 He has pulled down all upon him.
 What a terrible to-do!
 Dishes, glasses, snapt in two!
 Here a knife, and there a fork!
 Philip, this is cruel work.
 Table all so bare, and ah!
 Poor Papa, and poor Mamma
 Look quite cross, and wonder how
 They shall have their dinner now.



The Story of Johnny Head-in-Air



As he trudged along to
school,
It was always Johnny's rule
To be looking at the sky
And the clouds that floated
by;
But what just before him
lay,
In his way,
Johnny never thought
about;
So that every one cried out
"Look at little Johnny
there,
Little Johnny Head-In-
Air!"

Running just in Johnny's

way
Came a little dog one day;
Johnny's eyes were still
astray
Up on high,
In the sky;
And he never heard them
cry
"Johnny, mind, the dog is
nigh!"
Bump!
Dump!
Down they fell, with such a
thump,
Dog and Johnny in a lump!



Once, with head as high
as ever,
Johnny walked beside
the river.
Johnny watched the
swallows trying
Which was cleverest at
flying.
Oh! what fun!
Johnny watched the
bright round sun
Going in and coming
out;
This was all he thought
about.
So he strode on, only
think!
To the river's very
brink,
Where the bank was
high and steep,
And the water very
deep;
And the fishes, in a row,
Stared to see him
coming so.



One step more! oh! sad
to tell!
Headlong in poor
Johnny fell.

And the fishes, in
dismay,
Wagged their tails and
swam away.

There lay Johnny on his
face,
With his nice red
writing-case;
But, as they were
passing by,
Two strong men had
heard him cry;
And, with sticks, these
two strong men
Hooked poor Johnny
out again.



Oh! you should have seen him
shiver
When they pulled him from the
river.
He was in a sorry plight!
Dripping wet, and such a fright!
Wet all over, everywhere,
Clothes, and arms, and face, and
hair:
Johnny never will forget
What it is to be so wet.

And the fishes, one, two, three,
Are come back again, you see;
Up they came the moment after,
To enjoy the fun and laughter.
Each popped out his little head,
And, to tease poor Johnny, said
"Silly little Johnny, look,
You have lost your writing-
book!"



The Story of Flying Robert



When the rain comes tumbling
down
In the country or the town,
All good little girls and boys
Stay at home and mind their toys.
Robert thought, "No, when it
pours,
It is better out of doors."
Rain it did, and in a minute
Bob was in it.
Here you see him, silly fellow,
Underneath his red umbrella.

What a wind! oh! how it whistles
Through the trees and flowers and
thistles!
It has caught his red umbrella:
Now look at him, silly fellow—
Up he flies
To the skies.
No one heard his screams and cries;
Through the clouds the rude wind
bore him,
And his hat flew on before him.



Soon they got to such a height,
They were nearly out of sight.
And the hat went up so high,
That it nearly touched the sky.
No one ever yet could tell
Where they stopped, or where they
fell:
Only this one thing is plain,
Bob was never seen again!

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